



Product & Business Document

A verified rider and driver community for India

*An online platform that connects riders to each other.
It does not organise rides. It makes them findable, and
it makes the people on them accountable.*

PREPARED FOR	Founder, REV
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STATUS	Platform built and verified · pre-launch
LAUNCH MARKET	Chennai, Tamil Nadu

SECTION 01

Executive summary

REV is an online platform where verified motorcycle and car owners in India find each other and organise group rides. It is a **bridge, not a tour operator**. Members create the rides; REV makes them findable and makes the people on them accountable.

The decision that shapes everything else

You will not be physically present at rides. Treat that as the design principle, not a limitation. A platform that connects people is an **intermediary**; a platform that runs rides is an **organiser**. The first is defensible, scalable and cheap to operate. The second carries duty of care, needs insurance and staff in every city, and does not scale. Everything in this document assumes the first, and Section 02 sets out the lines that must not be crossed to stay there.

Where the product stands

The platform is built and verified. Phone-verified identity, member profiles, a vehicle Garage, ride creation with real road routing, rosters with capacity control, ride-scoped chat, reporting and blocking, an SOS path with emergency contacts, and a membership structure. The database enforces its own rules — a member cannot read another member's phone number or date of birth, cannot self-verify, cannot join a full ride, and cannot see a ride's exact meeting point until they have joined it. Those are not policies in a document; they are constraints the database refuses to break.

What it needs before launch

Item	Why it blocks launch	Effort
SMS provider (DLT-registered sender)	Phone verification is the product's foundation. Nothing works without it.	Days — external
Registered company	Gates the payment gateway, the DLT registration and the legal pages.	Weeks — external
Legal review of Terms and Privacy	Drafts exist. A lawyer must review before real members or money.	Weeks — external
Payment gateway	Only needed when paid membership switches on — not for launch.	Days — external
Ride captain recruitment	Twenty to thirty real captains. This is the actual launch work.	Weeks — yours

Every blocker is external or commercial. None is engineering.

The commercial thesis in one paragraph

Community platforms rarely get rich on member subscriptions alone — Indian consumer willingness to pay for a hobby app is low, and conversion in the low single digits is the honest planning assumption. The money is in **who wants access to a verified, high-intent motoring audience**: manufacturers, dealerships, tyre and gear brands, service chains, insurers and highway businesses. Subscriptions are how you prove the audience is real and engaged. Partnerships are how you monetise it. Build for the first, plan for the second.

SECTION 02

Positioning: bridge, not organiser

This section matters more than the product roadmap, because getting it wrong is the one mistake that cannot be undone by shipping features.

Why an intermediary is the right posture

Indian law treats a platform that merely hosts what its users publish very differently from one that provides the underlying service. An intermediary that does not initiate the transmission, does not select the participants, and does not modify the content has a recognised safe-harbour position, provided it observes due diligence and acts on complaints. The moment REV picks the route, appoints the leader, charges for the ride, or promises the experience, that protection weakens and REV starts to look like the party responsible for what happens on the road.

Lines that must not be crossed

Never take money for a specific ride. Membership is a fee for access to the platform. A per-ride fee is payment for an experience, and that makes you its seller.

Never appoint or employ ride leaders. Captains are members who chose to lead. They are not your staff, your agents, or "REV-certified guides".

Never publish a route as recommended, safe, or approved by REV. Routes are member-authored content that REV displays.

Never call REV the organiser — not in the app, not in marketing, not in a caption. The word matters if it is ever read back to you.

What you must do instead of being present

Absence is only defensible if the platform demonstrably does the things a responsible intermediary does. These are your obligations, and they are also your product differentiators — the same work that limits liability is what makes REV worth joining.

Instead of being there	The platform does this
Vetting who turns up	Phone verification for every member, with licence and registration checks as a higher tier. Identity is the product.
Watching behaviour on the road	Reporting and blocking built into every profile and ride. Reports are recorded, reviewed and acted on within a stated window.
Being reachable in an emergency	An SOS path that shares live location with the member's own nominated contacts — not with REV, and not with strangers.
Setting the safety standard	A published Ride Charter every captain accepts before creating a ride: gear, formation, pace, no racing, no impairment.
Knowing who is accountable	Every ride has a named, verified captain. Every roster is a list of real, contactable people. Nobody is anonymous.

The captain is your operating model

You cannot be at every ride, but a captain is at every ride by definition. Captains are the layer that makes an absent platform work: they set the pace, hold the roster, and own the brief. Your job is to make being a captain feel like

status worth having — visible standing, a track record, first access, eventually a share of what their community generates. Recruit and retain thirty good captains and the platform runs itself. Fail to, and no amount of product will save it.

SECTION 03

How the platform functions

The core loop

	Step	What happens	Why it matters
1	Verify	A one-time password to an Indian mobile number. One account per number.	Removes throwaway accounts. This is the entire moat.
2	Build a Garage	Make, model, year, modifications, photographs, riding style.	Identity worth having. Gives members a reason to return before any ride exists.
3	Find or lead	Browse rides by city and world, or create one as captain.	Supply and demand in the same screen.
4	Join	RSVP takes a seat. Capacity is enforced by the database, not the interface.	A roster that is actually true. No overbooking, no ghosts.
5	Coordinate	Ride-scoped chat, visible only to people who joined.	Replaces the WhatsApp group, with a verified roster attached.
6	Meet	Exact meeting point is released only to confirmed riders, close to the time.	A public listing never reveals where a named person will be.
7	Record	The ride completes; it counts toward the member's record.	Turns participation into standing, which is what people come back for.

Two worlds, one platform

REV runs as two parallel communities — two-wheeler and four-wheeler — sharing one account, one Garage and one reputation. They behave differently: motorcycle rides are frequent, early-morning and social; car drives are rarer, longer and more planned. Keeping them visually and editorially distinct while sharing infrastructure means one platform serves two audiences without either feeling like a guest in the other's house.

What the platform deliberately does not do

- **It does not take payment for rides.** Money moves between members offline, or not at all. See Section 02.
- **It does not track members during a ride.** Live location exists only inside an active SOS, and it goes to the member's own contacts.
- **It does not show phone numbers.** Ever, to anyone, on any screen. It is the promise most communities break first.
- **It does not rank or score members publicly.** Rides logged, yes. A public rating out of five turns a community into a marketplace and invites gaming.

SECTION 04

How REV makes money

Five streams, ordered by how quickly they can realistically produce revenue and how well each fits an intermediary that is not present at rides.

1 · Membership subscriptions — the base

A free tier that is genuinely useful, and a paid tier that pays for itself. This is the stream you control entirely and the one that proves the audience is real. Expect low single-digit conversion; design the paid tier so the members who do convert are the ones who ride most and evangelise hardest. Section 06 covers what actually makes someone pay.

2 · Brand and dealer partnerships — the real business

A verified, geolocated, high-intent motoring audience is valuable to people who sell to riders: manufacturers launching a model, dealerships wanting test rides, tyre and oil brands, gear retailers, service chains. This is not banner advertising — it is sponsored rides, launch experiences, and a place in the Garage when a member records what they own. It requires scale in one city before it is sellable, which is why density beats breadth.

3 · Commerce and affiliate — the margin

Gear, accessories, tyres, servicing, roadside cover and two-wheeler insurance are all things this audience buys anyway. A member who has recorded their exact machine in the Garage is the best-qualified lead a parts seller will ever get. Referral economics require no inventory, no logistics and no liability.

4 · Highway and hospitality partners — the local flywheel

Cafés, breakfast stops and resorts on popular corridors want groups of fifteen arriving on a Sunday morning. A listing fee or a per-visit arrangement is small money per partner but recurring, hyperlocal, and it makes routes better for members. It also gives captains something to offer their riders.

5 · Club and organiser tooling — the B2B option

Existing riding clubs, dealership owners' groups and event organisers already run this coordination badly on WhatsApp. Selling them a private space on REV — their roster, their rides, their branding — is higher revenue per account and far lower support cost than consumer subscriptions. Worth testing once the consumer product has proven itself.

Stream	Time to revenue	Effort	Ceiling	Fits "not present"?
Membership	Immediate at launch	Low	Moderate	Yes
Brand & dealer partnerships	After density in one city	High — sales work	High	Yes
Commerce & affiliate	Early, once Garage data exists	Low	Moderate	Yes
Highway & hospitality	Early, hyperlocal	Medium	Low per partner	Yes
Club & organiser tooling	After consumer proof	Medium	High per account	Yes

The stream to avoid

Charging a commission on a ride. It is the most obvious idea and the most dangerous one: it converts REV from a platform that lists rides into a business that sells them, with everything that follows in tax, liability and consumer-protection terms. If money must move for a ride, let it move between members and stay out of it.

SECTION 05

Illustrative economics

Read these as models, not forecasts

Every number below is an assumption chosen to show how the model behaves, not a prediction. The purpose is to identify which variable matters most — and it is not price. Replace each figure with a measured one as soon as you have it.

Cost to operate

The platform is deliberately cheap to run. Managed database and authentication, a static frontend, free mapping and routing, and per-message SMS. At launch scale the infrastructure is close to free; SMS is the only cost that grows with signups, and it grows with *verifications*, not with usage.

Cost line	At ~500 members	At ~5,000 members	Note
Database & auth hosting	Free tier	Low monthly tier	Scales in steps, not linearly
Frontend hosting	Free tier	Free to low	Static assets on a CDN
Maps & routing	Free	Free	Open tiles and open routing
SMS verification	Per signup only	Per signup only	The only truly variable cost
Payment gateway	Percentage of collections	Percentage of collections	Only on paid members
Moderation & support	Your time	First hire	The real cost at scale

The honest conclusion: technology is not your cost problem. Attention and moderation are.

What conversion has to do

The model below holds price constant and varies only the two things you actually control — how many members you have, and what fraction of them pay. It shows why chasing a higher price is the wrong instinct.

Members in city	Paying at 3%	Paying at 6%	Paying at 10%
500	15 members	30 members	50 members
2,000	60 members	120 members	200 members
5,000	150 members	300 members	500 members
15,000	450 members	900 members	1,500 members

At any plausible subscription price, a few hundred paying members in one city is a side income, not a company. That is not an argument against subscriptions — it is the argument for why subscriptions are the *proof*, and partnerships are the *business*. A brand paying for access to five thousand verified, active riders in Chennai is a materially larger cheque than those riders will ever write individually.

The number that decides everything

Not price. Not conversion. **Rides per active member per month.** A member who rides twice a month renews, invites friends and is worth showing to a sponsor. A member who rides twice a year churns and is worth nothing to anyone. Every product decision should be judged against whether it increases that number.

SECTION 06

Why anyone would pay

People do not subscribe to a feed. They subscribe to belonging, to access, or to something that saves them more than it costs. REV can offer all three, and should lead with the third because it is the easiest to believe.

The four reasons, in order of persuasive power

1 · It pays for itself

The most reliable subscription argument in India is arithmetic. If membership costs less than what it saves in a year on servicing, tyres, gear or fuel-stop discounts, the decision stops being emotional. This requires partnership work before it requires product work — and it is a reason to sign partners early even at unfavourable terms, because their discounts are your conversion engine.

2 · Access that cannot be bought elsewhere

- **Capped rides.** Small rosters with experienced captains, open to paid members first.
- **Early RSVP.** A head start on popular rides. Costs nothing, and scarcity is real.
- **Curated routes.** Corridors worth riding, with the stops that make them worth it.
- **Marquee runs.** The annual hill run, the coastal overnight — the ones people plan their year around.

3 · Standing inside the community

Riders care about how they are seen by other riders. A verified badge, a founding-member mark, a Garage that looks good, a visible record of rides led and ridden — these cost nothing to produce and are the reason people stay. Status is the cheapest retention mechanism ever invented, and the most durable.

4 · Safety that is worth money

Roadside assistance on ride days, a group accident cover, a verified-contact emergency chain. This is the tier that converts the rider's family as much as the rider. It requires an insurance or assistance partner, so it belongs in a later phase — but it is the single most defensible reason to charge, and worth building toward.

Suggested tier structure

	Free	Paid member	Captain / founding
Verified profile & Garage	Yes	Yes	Yes
Browse and join rides	Yes	Yes	Yes
Ride chat & roster	Yes	Yes	Yes
Create rides	Limited	Unlimited	Unlimited
Early RSVP window	—	Yes	Yes
Partner discounts	—	Yes	Yes
Capped & curated rides	—	Yes	Yes

	Free	Paid member	Captain / founding
Ride-day assistance cover	—	Later phase	Later phase
Standing & recognition	—	Member mark	Captain mark, founding badge

Keep the free tier genuinely good. A crippled free tier kills the density that makes the paid tier worth buying.

SECTION 07

Honest assessment

What works in your favour

Strength	Why it is real
Verification is a genuine moat	Anyone can build a listings app. Building one where every member is a real, contactable, accountable person is a standard that is hard to retrofit and harder to fake.
The platform is already built	Most people at this stage have a pitch deck. You have a working, security-audited product. That converts months of risk into weeks of go-to-market.
Operating costs are near zero	You can run this for a long time without revenue, which means you can wait for density instead of forcing monetisation early and killing the community.
Not being present is a feature	It keeps you out of duty-of-care territory, keeps costs flat as you add cities, and makes the model expandable without hiring in each one.
The audience already spends	This is not a market you must convince to care. Riders already spend on gear, servicing and travel. You are intercepting existing spend, not creating new demand.

What works against you

Risk	Severity	What it actually means
Cold start	Critical	An empty feed is worthless. No rides means no riders means no rides. This kills most community products and it is the problem to solve before any other.
WhatsApp is free and already there	High	Your competitor is not another app. It is a habit with zero friction. You must be clearly better at something WhatsApp is clearly bad at — trust, discovery and rosters.
A serious incident	Existential	If someone is badly hurt on a ride found through REV, terms of use will not protect the brand even where they protect the entity. Safety posture is reputation management.
Low willingness to pay	High	Indian consumers pay reluctantly for hobby software. Assume this and build the partnership stream in parallel rather than discovering it late.
Seasonality and churn	Medium	Riding is weather- and season-dependent. Annual billing and off-season content matter more than they would elsewhere.
Moderation load	Medium	Every community platform eventually gets harassment, spam and disputes. It arrives sooner than founders expect and it costs time, not money.
Founder concentration	Medium	One person cannot recruit captains, moderate, sell partnerships and build. Sequence it or find a partner for the parts you will not do well.

SECTION 08

Launch strategy

The entire launch problem is the cold start. Everything below is subordinate to solving it.

Recruit supply, not demand

Do not launch to riders. Launch to **captains**. Twenty to thirty people who already lead rides in Chennai, who already have a WhatsApp group, and who already do this coordination badly. Bring them on individually, by hand, before any public launch. Each one arrives with a group. A rider who opens REV and sees eight real rides this weekend stays; one who sees an empty feed never returns, and you only get one attempt at them.

Win one corridor completely

Not Chennai. **East Coast Road**. One corridor, one riding culture, one set of breakfast stops. Density on a single route beats presence across a city, because a rider judges the platform by whether it has something for them *this Sunday* — not by how many cities it covers. Own ECR completely, then GST Road, then Bengaluru.

Establish a ritual

A community needs a heartbeat. One anchor ride at the same time every week, reliably, whether four people come or forty. Rituals create habit, habit creates retention, and retention is what you will be selling to partners. This is the single highest-leverage thing you can personally do, and it does not require you to be on the ride — only to make sure it happens.

Go where riders already are

- **Service centres and dealerships** on Saturday mornings — the highest concentration of your exact audience anywhere.
- **Existing WhatsApp groups** — do not compete with them, recruit their admins as captains and let them keep their group.
- **Breakfast stops on ECR** — the cafés already know the regulars, and they want the groups.
- **Gear and accessory shops** — natural first partners for the discount programme that makes membership pay for itself.

Sequence

Phase	Focus	What "done" looks like
0 · Close the blockers	Company, SMS provider, legal review	Real phone verification working end to end
1 · Seed supply	Recruit 20–30 captains by hand, seed real rides	Eight or more genuine rides listed for the coming weekend
2 · Private beta	Captains bring their groups. Invite only.	300–500 verified members; the weekly anchor ride is running
3 · Open launch	Public signups, one city, one corridor	Rides happening without you prompting them
4 · Monetise	Partner discounts first, then paid tier	Membership demonstrably saves more than it costs

Phase	Focus	What "done" looks like
5 · Expand	Second corridor, then second city	The playbook repeats without new engineering

SECTION 09

Safety and risk management

You are not present at rides, so the platform must carry the safety posture. This is both an obligation and the strongest reason a cautious rider — or their family — chooses REV over a WhatsApp group.

Measure	Status	Purpose
Phone verification for every member	Built	No anonymous participants. Everyone is contactable and accountable.
Exact meeting point withheld until joined	Built	A public listing never discloses where a named person will physically be.
Phone numbers never displayed	Built	Removes the most common harassment vector in community platforms.
Report and block, on every profile and ride	Built	Members police the community; you act on what is reported.
SOS with member-nominated contacts	Built	Emergency help reaches the people who can actually act, not a support inbox.
Immutable audit log	Built	Every consequential action is recorded, which matters if anything is ever disputed.
Published Ride Charter, accepted by captains	To write	Sets the standard in writing and evidences the platform's diligence.
Incident response procedure	To write	A stated process for what happens within an hour, a day and a week of an incident.
Licence and registration verification tier	Later phase	Raises verification from "real person" to "legally entitled to be on the road".
Insurance or assistance partnership	Later phase	Converts safety from a promise into a product members will pay for.

The thing to decide before launch, not after

Write the incident response procedure now, while nothing has happened. Who is called, in what order, within what time. What is said publicly and what is not. Who speaks for REV. A community forgives an accident it could not have prevented; it does not forgive a platform that appeared not to care in the hours afterwards.

SECTION 10

What to measure

Vanity metrics will mislead you here. Signups are easy to generate and mean nothing. These are the numbers that actually indicate whether this is working.

Metric	Why it is the honest one	Healthy signal
Rides created per week	Supply is the constraint. This is the number that predicts everything downstream.	Rising without you prompting it
Rides per active member per month	The single best indicator of whether REV is a habit or a curiosity.	Above one, and climbing
Roster fill rate	Whether listed rides actually attract people, or sit empty.	Most rides more than half full
Show-up rate against RSVP	The trust metric. If people RSVP and do not appear, the core promise is failing.	High and stable
Repeat captains	A captain who leads a second ride has validated the product better than any survey.	Most captains lead again
Week-four retention	Whether the community survives the novelty period.	Flattening rather than decaying
Reports per hundred rides	Community health. Zero is suspicious; rising is a warning.	Low, stable, all resolved

The question to ask every month

"If I stopped promoting REV entirely for one month, would rides still happen?" Until the answer is yes, you have an initiative rather than a community — and no amount of monetisation work will change that.

SECTION 11

Appendix — what is built today

Recorded so the commercial plan can be read against the actual state of the product rather than an intention.

Working and verified

Area	Detail
Identity	Phone-based sign-up and sign-in, account creation with 18+ enforcement, consent recorded with version and timestamp, editable profile, data export, and account deletion that genuinely erases.
Garage	Vehicle records per world with make, model, year, modifications, riding style and photographs. Persists across sessions.
Rides	Creation with real road routing, live map preview, capacity control enforced by the database, rosters, join and leave, captain roster management, and a lifecycle that derives upcoming, live and completed from the clock.
Communication	Ride-scoped chat readable only by confirmed riders, delivered in real time.
Trust & safety	Reporting, blocking, emergency contacts and an SOS path, plus an immutable audit log.
Membership	Tier structure and records in place; payment collection deliberately not connected.

Security posture

- Every table enforces row-level security, denying by default rather than permitting by default.
- Phone numbers and dates of birth live in a schema the public interface cannot reach on any code path — not a policy, a structural impossibility.
- Exact meeting coordinates are held separately and released only to a ride's confirmed roster.
- Trust signals such as verification status cannot be set by a member, only earned.
- Capacity is enforced atomically, so two riders cannot take the same last seat.
- Verified by an adversarial test suite covering privilege escalation, data leakage, roster tampering and unauthorised access; the hosting provider's security advisor reports no warnings.

Not yet built

- Ride recaps and post-ride photo galleries.
- Photograph upload to permanent storage — currently placeholders.
- Payment collection and the live membership purchase flow.
- Licence and vehicle registration verification.
- Push notifications.
- Native mobile applications — the platform is a responsive web app today.

This document contains illustrative financial models, not forecasts, and is not legal, tax or investment advice. The Terms of Use and Privacy Policy referenced here are drafts that require review by a qualified Indian lawyer before REV accepts members or

payments.